reality—the absolute. On the foundation of the early Vedanta, Shankara (or Shankaracharya) built a system which is called the *Advaita Vedanta* or non-dualist Vedanta. It is this philosophy which represents the dominant philosophic outlook of Hinduism to-day. It is based on pure monism, the only ultimate reality in the metaphysical sense being the *Atman,* the Absolute Soul. That is the subject, all else is objective. How that Absolute Soul pervades everything, how the one appears as the many, and yet retains its wholeness, for the Absolute is indivisible and cannot be divided, all this cannot be accounted for by the processes of logical reasoning, for our minds are limited by the finite world. The Upanishad had described this *Atman,* if this can be called a description thus:

'Whole is that, whole (too) is this; from whole, whole cometh;
take whole from whole, (yet) whole remains.'

Shankara builds a subtle and intricate theory of knowledge and proceeding from certain assumptions, step by step, by logical argument, leads up to the complete system of advaitism or non-dualism. The individual soul is not a separate entity but that Absolute Soul itself though limited in some ways. It is compared